AI BADGE

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Your AI Workspace

The Problem

If your AI feels forgetful, it is not the AI.
It is your folder structure.

Most people give AI scattered fragments. Today we fix that in eight minutes.

The folder is (in part) the agent, for context.

01 AI tools that read your machine

Claude Code, ChatGPT Desktop, Cursor, Gemini for Workspace all infer what you are working on from your folder names and structure.

02 Pasted files carry context

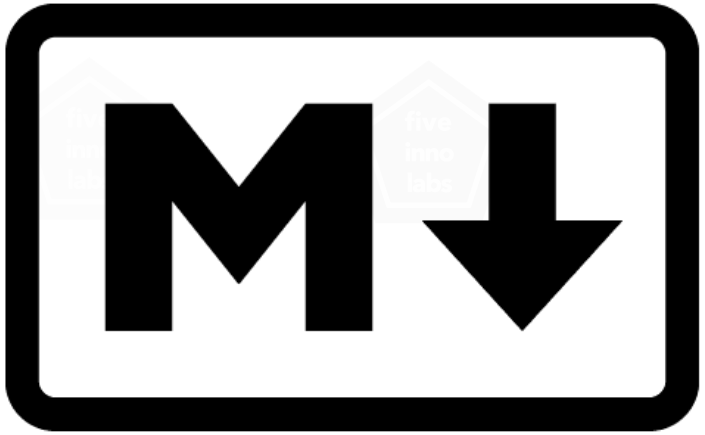
When you drag a file into a chat, the assistant uses where it lives in your tree to make sense of it. Tidy tree = tidy answers.

03 Future you finds things in seconds

The cheapest productivity upgrade in your life is a folder you can name out loud.

AI's native tongue.

By 2026, markdown is the lingua franca for agents.



- **Parsed better, fewer tokens**

  LLMs read clean markdown more accurately than .docx, .pdf, or rich text, and burn fewer tokens doing it.

- **Native output of every modern AI**

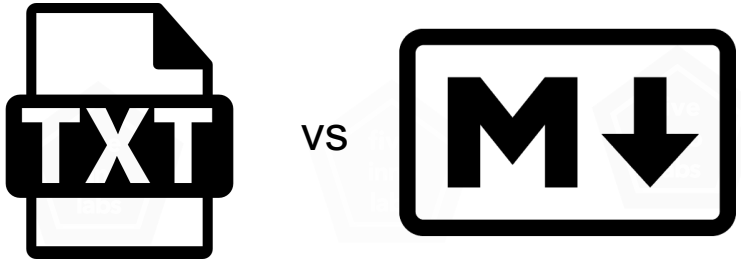
  ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Copilot all produce markdown by default. Meeting it in its own format compounds.

- **Plain text. Forever.**

  It is just `# heading`, `- bullet`, `**bold**`. Opens anywhere, breaks nowhere, survives every tool change.

Markdown vs text files

By 2026, markdown is the lingua franca for agents.



Format	Best for	Pros	Cons
.txt	Raw notes, logs, transcripts, simple dumps	Universal, minimal, no formatting assumptions	Harder to scan; weak hierarchy; code/instructions can blur together
.md	Agent instructions, specs, README files, plans, architecture notes	Human-readable + machine-readable; supports headings, lists, code fences, checklists; standard in repos	Slight formatting discipline needed; Markdown flavours can differ slightly

One folder. Three subfolders. Three files.

```
📁 my-ai-workspace/
├── 📄 README.md
├── 📄 CLAUDE.md
├── 📁 personas/
├── 📁 skills/
└── 📁 notes/
    └── 📄 notes.md
```

personas/

Filled in Lesson 8: your five AI teammates.

skills/

Filled in Lesson 9: their reusable recipes.

notes/

Your scratchpad. Ideas, links, half-thoughts.

README.md

Five lines on what this folder is.

CLAUDE.md

Optional: the always-on context for any AI.

Every project starts with these.

README.md

What this folder is. Why it exists.

```
# My AI Workspace

A small home for the
AI tools, personas,
and notes I am
building.

Owner: Heather
```

CLAUDE.md

Always-on context for any AI.

```
# Working with me

- Be direct, be warm.
- I run a small
  literacy non-profit.
- Default tone:
  encouraging, plain.
- No em dashes.
```

notes.md

Scratchpad. Half-formed thoughts.

```
# Notes

## 2026-05-08
- Read the AI Badge
  Lesson 6 transcript
- Try the Designer
  agent on the spring
  fundraising letter
```

A home your AI can read.

Empty today. Furnished over the next two lessons.

LESSON 8 →

Your AI Team

Build five personas (Scientist, Designer, Maker, Communicator, Manager) tailored to your work.

LESSON 9 →

Your First Skill

Give one of your personas a reusable recipe it can run on demand.

BEYOND →

Your Backlog

Add personas, add skills, refine. The folder is the team.